EXPERIMENT-06: Extracting Browser Artifacts

AIM:

To extract and examine browser artifacts, including browsing history, cached files, visited URLs, and associated timestamps using forensic utilities.

TOOLS REQUIRED:

1. ChromeHistoryView
2. ChromeCacheView
3. IEHistoryView
4. IECacheView
5. Windows computer with browser data available

PROCEDURE:

Step 1: Download the Tools

- Download the utilities from the official NirSoft website and extract the downloaded ZIP files.
- ChromeHistoryView: https://www.nirsoft.net/utils/chrome_history_view.html
- ChromeCacheView: https://www.nirsoft.net/utils/chrome_cache_view.html
- IEHistoryView: https://www.nirsoft.net/utils/ie_history_view.html
- IECacheView: https://www.nirsoft.net/utils/ie_cache_view.html

Step 2: Examine Browser History

- Launch ChromeHistoryView.
- Select the available Chrome history database or user profile.
- Examine visited URLs, page titles, visit counts, and timestamps.
- Export relevant records if required.

Step 3: Examine Browser Cache

- Open ChromeCacheView.
- Load or locate the supported Chrome cache directory.

- Examine cached URLs, content types, file sizes, and access information.
- Record relevant findings.

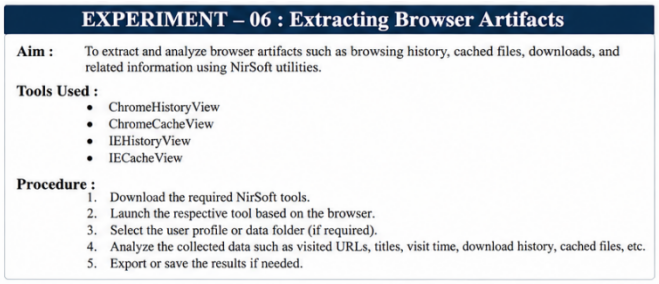
Step 4: Examine Internet Explorer Artifacts

- Launch IEHistoryView to inspect available Internet Explorer history records.
- Open IECacheView to examine supported Internet Explorer cache data.
- Record the available URLs, timestamps, and cache metadata.

Note: Internet Explorer is retired. These tools may be useful for legacy artifacts, but compatibility depends on the Windows version and available data.

Step 5: Document Findings

Record relevant browser artifacts and timestamps in an observation table. Export results where supported and capture screenshots of the actual application output.

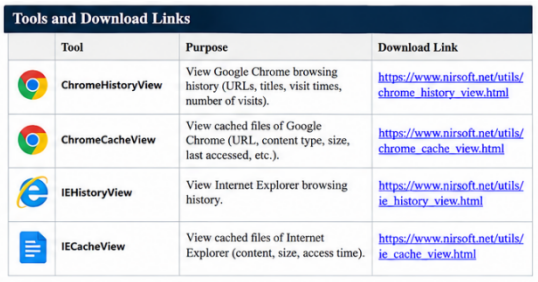


EXPERIMENT – 06 : Extracting Browser Artifacts

Aim : To extract and analyze browser artifacts such as browsing history, cached files, downloads, and related information using NirSoft utilities.

Tools Used :
- ChromeHistoryView
- ChromeCacheView
- IEHistoryView
- IECacheView

Procedure :
1. Download the required NirSoft tools.
2. Launch the respective tool based on the browser.
3. Select the user profile or data folder (if required).
4. Analyze the collected data such as visited URLs, titles, visit time, download history, cached files, etc.
5. Export or save the results if needed.



Tools and Download Links

Tool	Purpose	Download Link
ChromeHistoryView	View Google Chrome browsing history (URLs, titles, visit times, number of visits).	https://www.nirsoft.net/utils/chrome_history_view.html
ChromeCacheView	View cached files of Google Chrome (URL, content type, size, last accessed, etc.).	https://www.nirsoft.net/utils/chrome_cache_view.html
IEHistoryView	View Internet Explorer browsing history.	https://www.nirsoft.net/utils/ie_history_view.html
IECacheView	View cached files of Internet Explorer (content, size, access time).	https://www.nirsoft.net/utils/ie_cache_view.html

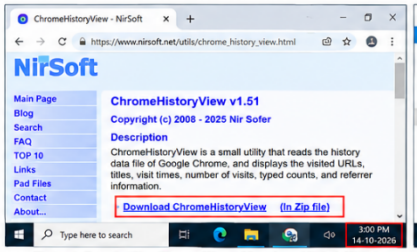


Figure 1: Downloading ChromeHistoryView from NirSoft Website

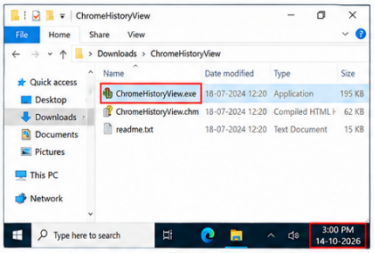


Figure 2: Extracted ChromeHistoryView Files

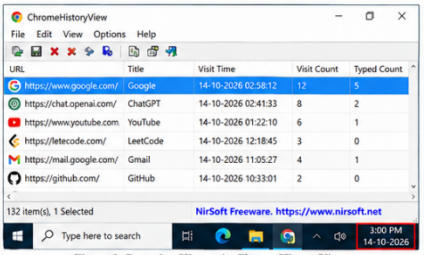


Figure 3: Browsing History in ChromeHistoryView

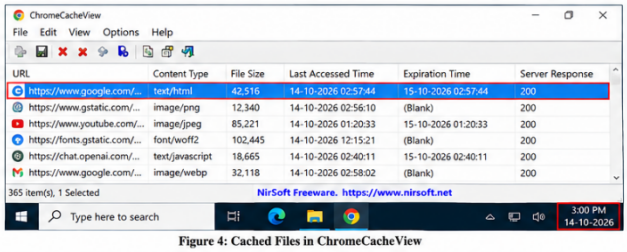


Figure 4: Cached Files in ChromeCacheView

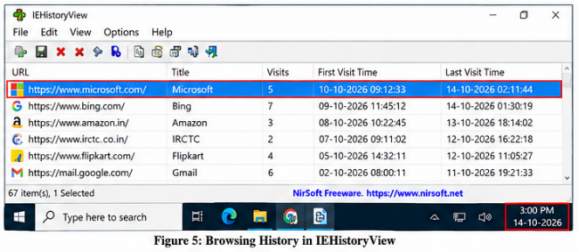


Figure 5: Browsing History in IEHistoryView

RESULT:

1. The tools successfully extracted detailed browsing history and cache information.
2. Investigators obtained a timeline and context of user internet activities.
3. The extracted artifacts aided in constructing web usage profiles, valuable for forensic and investigative purposes.